

Halden Distribution Ltd. — who can reach what (business view)

For: managers and department heads · **From:** IT · **Date:** 2026-10-02 **Companion to:** `p06-network-access-policy.md` (the policy) and `../configs/p06-zone-rule-matrix.md` (the technical rule list)

Why a diagram-free version

The technical rule list is written for engineers: it names ports and services. This page says the same thing in business terms, so a manager can check it without needing to know what port 445 is.

The building, in zones

Think of the network as a building with separate floors and doors that need a key card.

Floor (zone)	Who is on it	Who can get in
Server room	The systems that hold our identity, files and backups	Staff, for the specific services they need; the warehouse, the same; IT. Nobody else
Warehouse network	Site 2 devices, connected by an encrypted tunnel	Warehouse staff, IT
Office floor	Staff laptops and desktops	Staff, IT
IT control room	IT's admin workstation, the virtualisation host, the backup server, switch and Wi-Fi management	IT only. Not guests, not devices, and not remote staff
Visitor area	Visitors' phones and laptops	Internet only. Visitors cannot see each other or us
Equipment network	Printers, the CCTV recorder, warehouse scanners	One shared folder for scanning, and name look-up. No internet, by design
Working from home	Staff connected through the VPN	The same as being in the office — except the IT control room, which stays closed

What this is designed to prevent, in plain terms

If this happens...	...this is what it can reach
A visitor's laptop is infected	The internet connection only. Nothing at Halden
A staff laptop is infected by ransomware	That laptop, and the file shares that user could already open. It cannot reach the domain controllers, the backup server or the CCTV system
A printer or the CCTV recorder is compromised	One shared folder. It cannot reach the servers, staff laptops or the internet
A home worker's laptop is compromised	The same as a user in the office — and it still cannot reach IT's control room

If this happens...	...this is what it can reach
Someone guesses the old Wi-Fi password	Nothing: that password no longer exists. Only devices holding a certificate from our own authority can join the corporate network

What staff will notice

1. **Corporate Wi-Fi:** the password is replaced by certificates. Company laptops connect automatically once set up; a personal phone will not connect to the corporate network at all. Visitors use the guest network with a voucher from reception.

1. **Working from home:** instead of a remote desktop link, there is a VPN client, a sign-in, and an approval on your phone. It takes about 20 seconds longer to connect and is far safer.

1. **A folder or system you used to reach may need a request.** If a tool needs access it does not have, raise a ticket naming the system and the reason; IT will grant the narrowest access that does the job and record who owns it.

What it costs the business

- **No new licences.** The controls are configuration on systems we already run.
- **A maintenance window** outside working hours for the migration, done one zone at a time.
- **A small amount of change** for staff, mainly the Wi-Fi and the VPN sign-in.
- **One ongoing commitment:** when someone moves role or leaves, their remote access is removed at the

same time as their account. That is already part of the joiner-mover-leaver process.

What it deliberately does not do

- It does **not** make Halden unhackable, and it does not replace patching, backups or anti-virus.
- It does **not** protect against someone who already has valid credentials for a system they are allowed to use — that is what activity monitoring is for (P7).
- It **will** need occasional exceptions. Each one is written down with an owner and a review date, so that "temporary" does not quietly become permanent.

Status: prepared for review. This is the business-facing view of the decisions in the rule matrix; the technical detail lives there and in `../docs/00-design.md`.